UNIT 1 · TOPIC 8(A)

Orchard Equipment

Syllabus topic: Equipment for orchard and plantation crops: coconut, areca nut, cashew nut

Orchard-specific equipment, collected from across Unit 1:

Tillage

- **Offset disc harrow** — works offset to the tractor centre-line, so it can till under tree canopies.

Spraying

- **Air-blast / air-carrier orchard sprayer:** 10–40 bar liquid + an air stream; the air displaces and carries droplets into the canopy. Centrifugal pumps supply the high volume.
- **Rocker sprayer:** 14–28 bar, for tall trees with an extension lance.
- High-volume spraying for trees means **>1000 L/ha**.
- Piston/plunger pumps give the high pressure orchard sprayers need; mechanical agitation is more economical on high-pressure orchard sprayers.

Harvesting aids

- Trunk/limb shakers with catching frames, hydraulic elevating platforms/ladders, pneumatic secateurs (see Topic 7f).